ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 79

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Luganda Alphabet

Ennukuta z'Oluganda

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 24 Luganda Letters with English Phonetics

A a Ŋ ŋ Z z

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Luganda Alphabet — Ennukuta z'Oluganda
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 79

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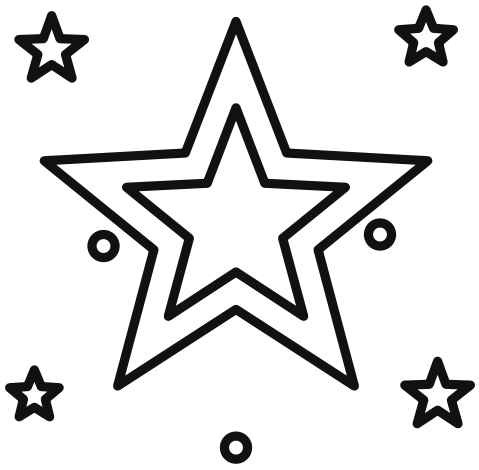
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



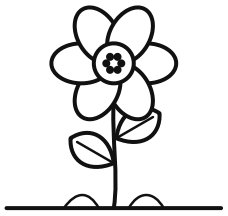
This book belongs to

Ekitabo kino kya

I started learning Luganda on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 79 is Luganda. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Luganda has no strong stress: say every syllable evenly, and let long (double) vowels last twice as long: *caa-yee*.
- A **double consonant** (*bb, ss, kk, ŋŋ*) is held a little longer and said strongly: *ssah-bboo-nee*.
- **c** is always 'ch' as in "church"; **ŋ** is the 'ng' at the end of "sing".
- Luganda is a **tonal** language: high and low voice pitch can change a word. Listen to a Luganda speaker to hear the music!

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Luganda name** written in Luganda (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Luganda name · syllables* shows the name Luganda children use for the letter (B is «ba», C is «ca») and its row of syllables.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Luganda as spoken in Kampala and Buganda.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Luganda! Oluganda

oh-loo-gah-ndah — the Luganda word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **10 million people** speak Luganda as their first language, and millions more use it as a second language.[3]

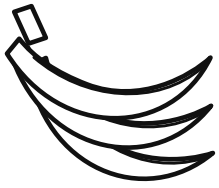
Where?
In **Uganda**: in the central region around **Kampala** and along the northern shores of **Lake Victoria**, and in markets and towns all over the country.

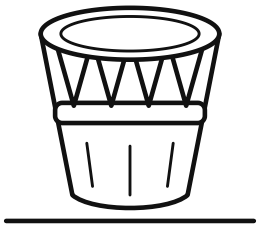
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**. Double letters show long and strong sounds.

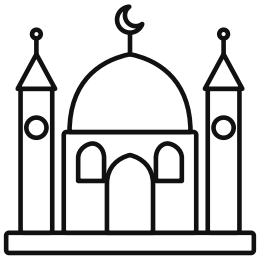
How many letters?
24 letters, including **NY** and the special letter **Ŋ**.

One root, many words
A **Muganda** is one person, the **Baganda** are the people, **Buganda** is the land and **Luganda** is the language!

Did you know?
Some Luganda words came from Arabic through Swahili: *kitabo* (book, from *kitāb*), *kkalaamu* (pen, from *qalam*), *essaawa* (clock, from *sāʿa*) and *ssabbuuni* (soap, from *ṣābūn*).





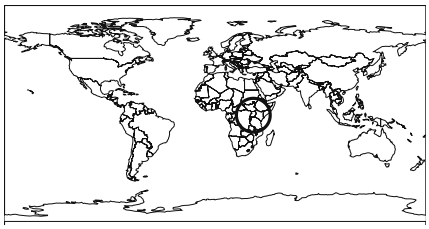


The Luganda Alphabet ennukuta

24 letters — ennukuta z'Oluganda

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Cc** *chah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*
Gg *gah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*
Nn *nah*	**Ny ny** *nyah*	**Ŋŋ** *ngah*	**Oo** *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Rr** *rah*
Ss *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Uu** *oo*	**Ww** *wah*	**Yy** *yah*	**Zz** *zah*

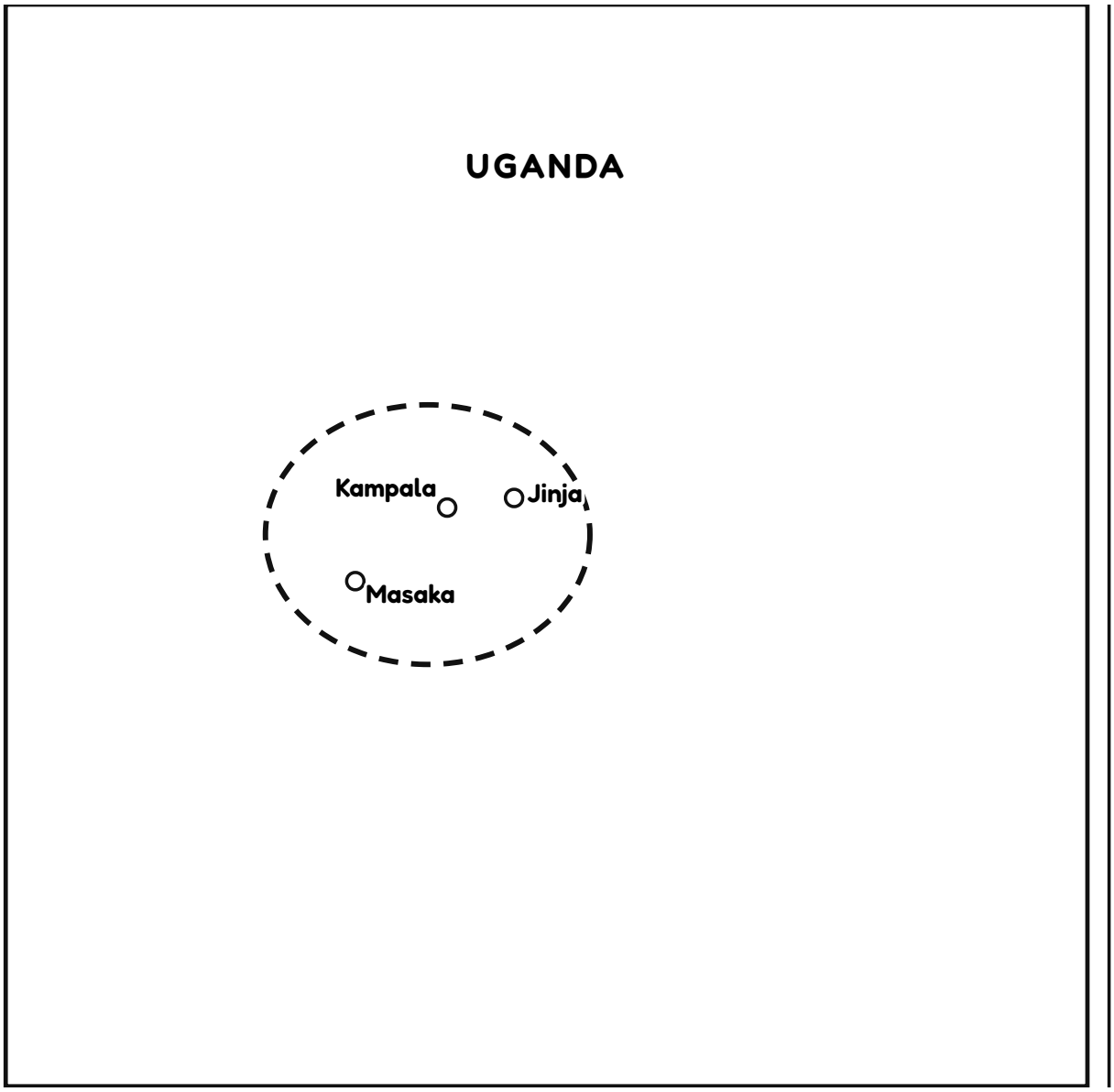
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Uganda in East Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Luganda spoken?



Color it: the land **green**. **Find it:** Luganda is spoken in Kampala, Jinja and Masaka, in the middle of Uganda, near the shores of Lake Victoria. The dashed line shows where most Luganda speakers live.

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The Letters ennukuta z'Oluganda

en-noo-koo-tah zoh-loo-gah-ndah — "the letters of Luganda"

Luganda is written with **24 letters**. It has no H, Q, V or X, and two letters of its own: **NY** and **Ŋ**.

Say it twice!
A **double vowel** is said long: *caayi* (tea). A **double consonant** is said strong: *ssabbuuni* (soap). Luganda spelling shows you exactly how long each sound is.

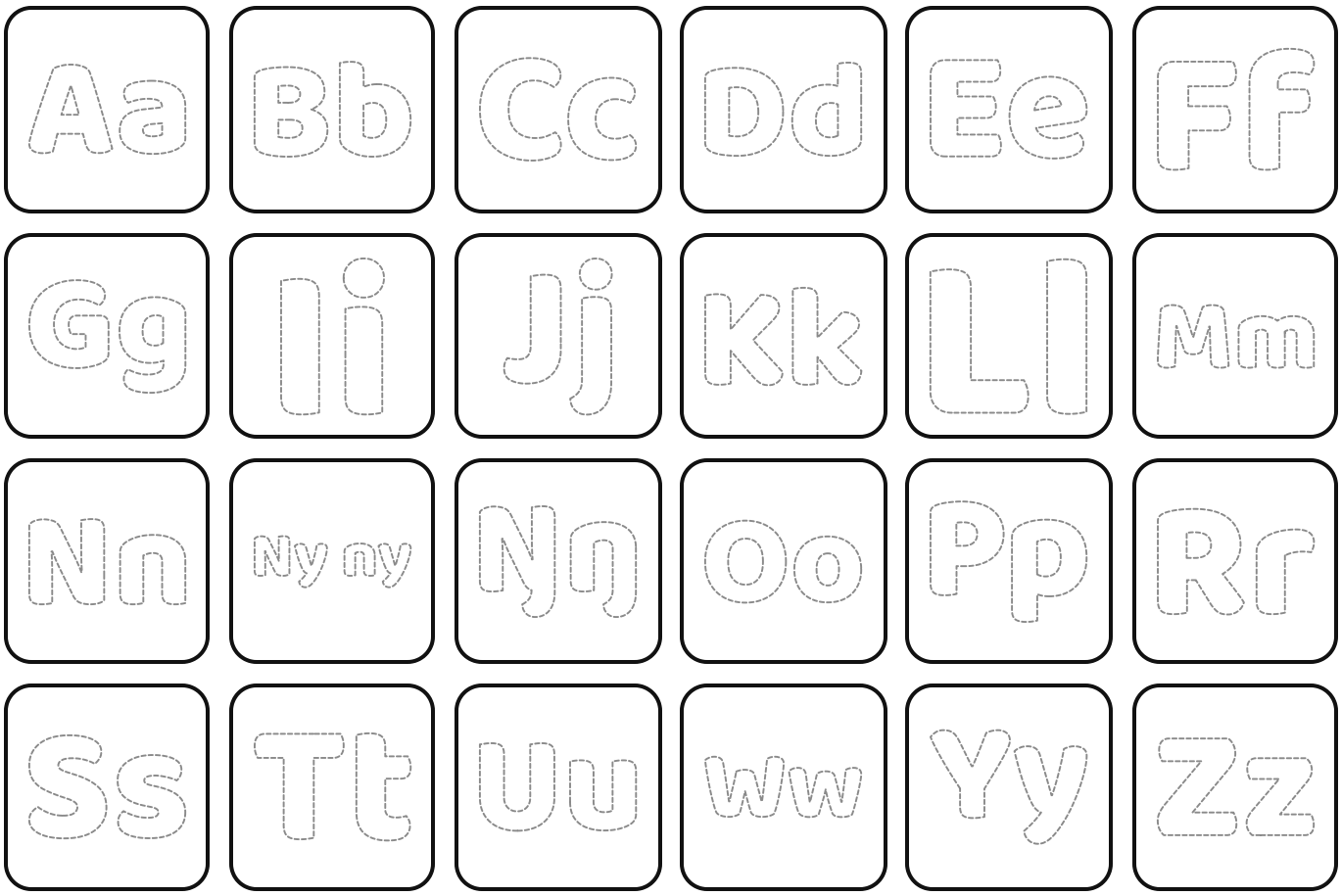
"Kino kitabo!"
Most Luganda naming words start with a little vowel: *e*kitabo, *o*muti, *a*mazzi. When you say "this is a …", it drops off: *Kino kitabo!* — "This is a book!" So some words in this book start without it.

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters ennukuta z'Oluganda

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · ERINNYA

a

ah

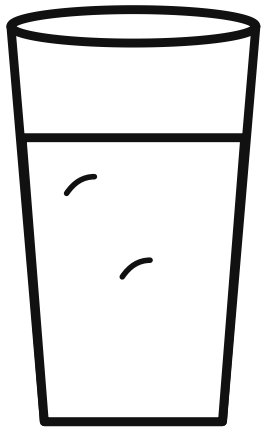
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma · na



AA **IS FOR**

amazzi

ah-mah-zzee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · ERINNYA

ba

bah

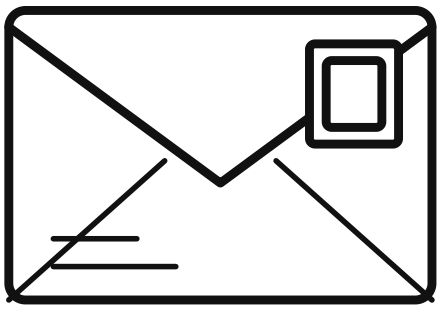
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



BB IS FOR

bbaluwa

bbah-loo-wah

a letter to post

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Cc

NAME · ERINNYA

ca

chah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “church” — never ‘k’ or ‘s’

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

C c — «ca»

ca · ce · ci · co · cu



CC IS FOR

ccupa

cchoo-pah

bottle

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Cc Cc Cc Cc

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Dd

NAME · ERINNYA

da

dah

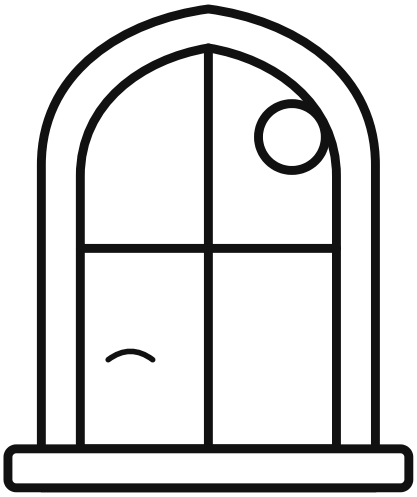
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du



DD IS FOR

ddirisa

ddee-ree-sah

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · ERINNYA

e

eh

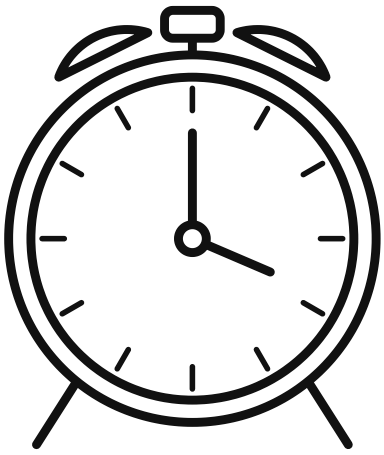
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me · ne



EE IS FOR

essaawa

eh-ssaa-wah

clock, watch

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · ERINNYA

fa

fah

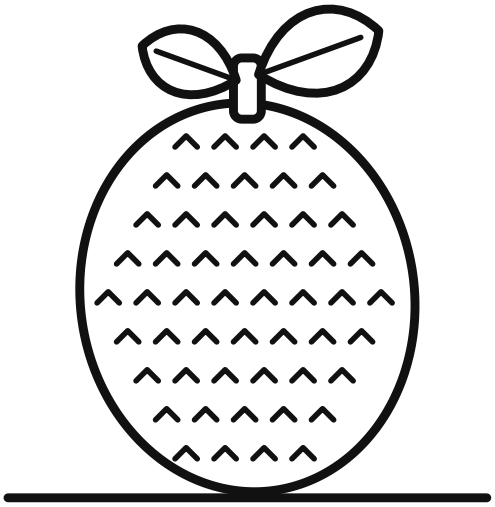
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

ffene

ffeh-neh

jackfruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · ERINNYA

ga

gah

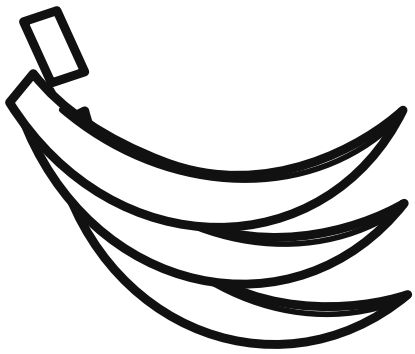
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

gonja

goh-njah

sweet plantain (a big banana for roasting)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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NAME · ERINNYA

i

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

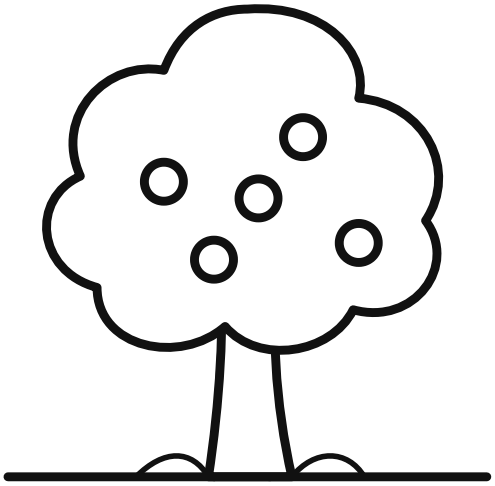
‘ee’ as in “see”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi · ni

Luganda naming words never start with l. Find it at the end of *omuti*!



II IS FOR

omuti

oh-moo-tee

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA



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Jj

NAME · ERINNYA

ja

jah

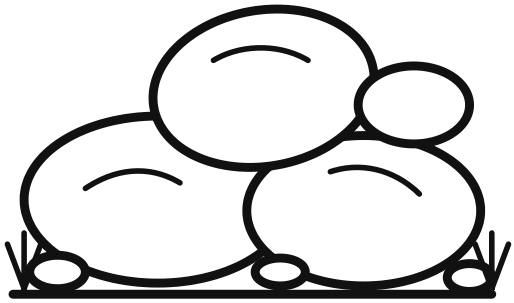
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



JJ IS FOR

jjinja

jjee-njah

stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · ERINNYA

ka

kah

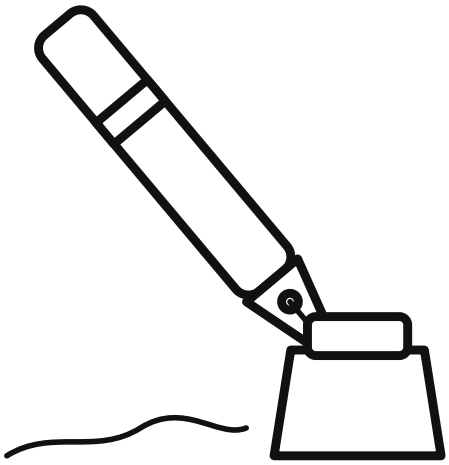
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku



KK IS FOR

kkalaamu

kkah-laa-moo

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · ERINNYA

la

lah

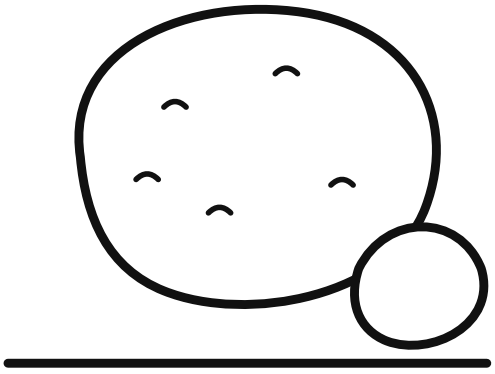
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

lumonde

loo-moh-ndeh

sweet potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · ERINNYA

ma

mah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

mwezi

mweh-zee

moon, month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · ERINNYA

na

nah

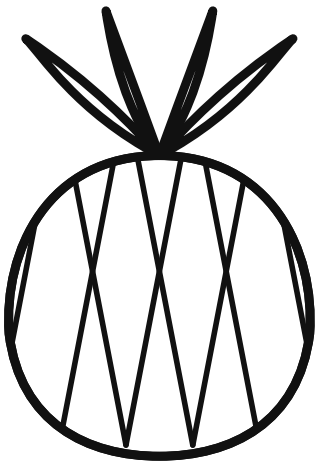
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

nnanaasi

nnah-naa-see

pineapple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Ny ny

NAME · ERINNYA

nya

nyah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

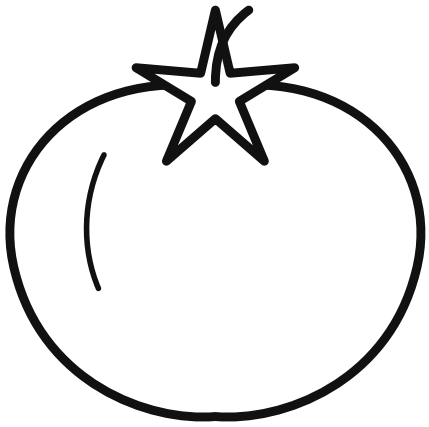
‘ny’ as in “canyon” — one letter in Luganda!

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu

NY counts as **one letter** of the Luganda alphabet.



NY NY IS FOR

nnyaanya

nnyaa-nyah

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Ŋŋ

NAME · ERINNYA

ŋa

ngah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

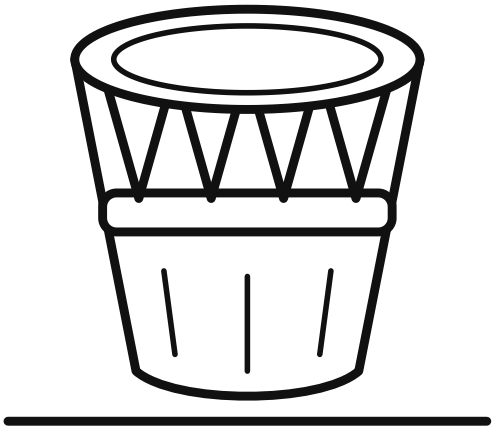
‘ng’ as in “sing” — but Luganda can start a word with it!

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

Ŋ ŋ — «ŋa»

ŋa · ŋe · ŋi · ŋo · ŋu

ŋ = “si**ng**” · ng = “fi**ng**er”



ŊŊ IS FOR

ŋŋoma

ngngoh-mah

drum

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ŋŋ Ŋŋ Ŋŋ Ŋŋ

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Oo

NAME · ERINNYA

o

oh

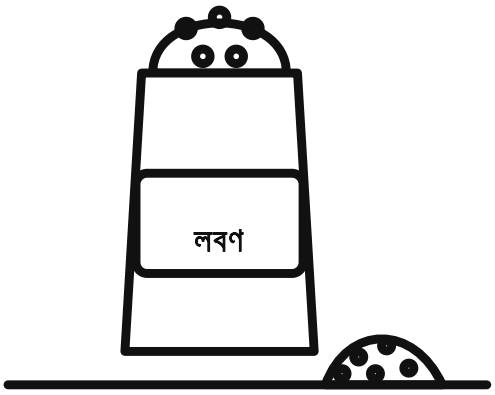
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “more” (short and pure)

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo · no



OO IS FOR

omunnyo

oh-moo-nnyoh

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · ERINNYA

pa

pah

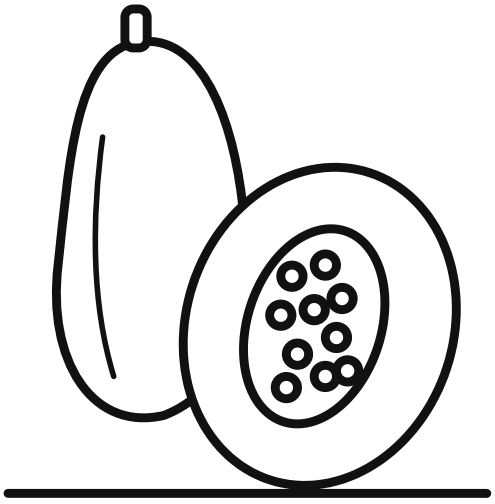
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



PP IS FOR

ppaapaali

ppaa-paa-lee

papaya

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Rr

NAME · ERINNYA

ra

rah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick tapped ‘r’ — used only after **e** or **i**

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru

L after a, o, u · R after e, i

R never starts a Luganda word: it comes after E or I, where L would be. Find it in *omuceere*!



RR IS FOR

omuceere

oh-moo-cheh-reh

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss

NAME · ERINNYA

sa

sah

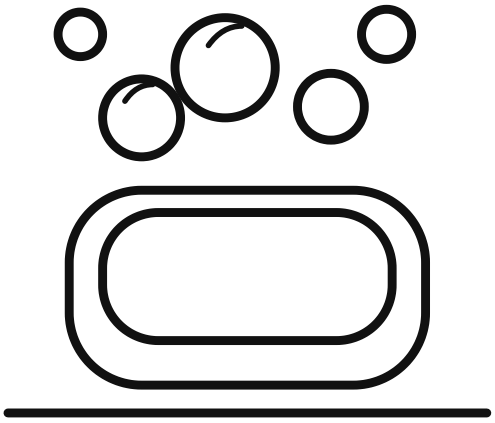
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

ssabbuuni

ssah-bboo-nee

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · ERINNYA

ta

tah

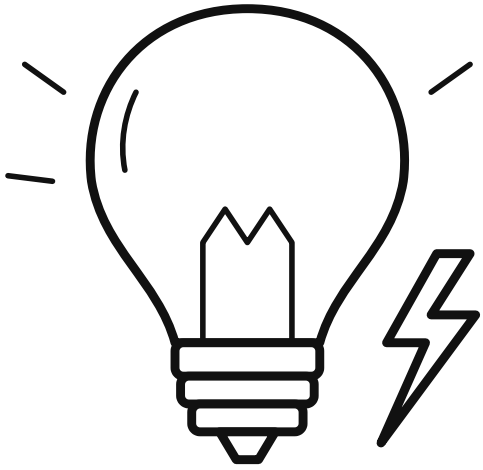
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “tap”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu



TT IS FOR

ttaala

ttaa-lah

lamp, light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · ERINNYA

u

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

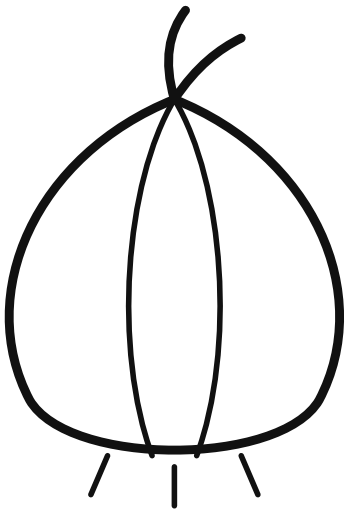
‘oo’ as in “moon”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu · nu

Few Luganda words start with U. Find it three times in *katungulu*!



UU IS FOR

katungulu

kah-too-ngoo-loo

onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Ww

NAME · ERINNYA

wa

wah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

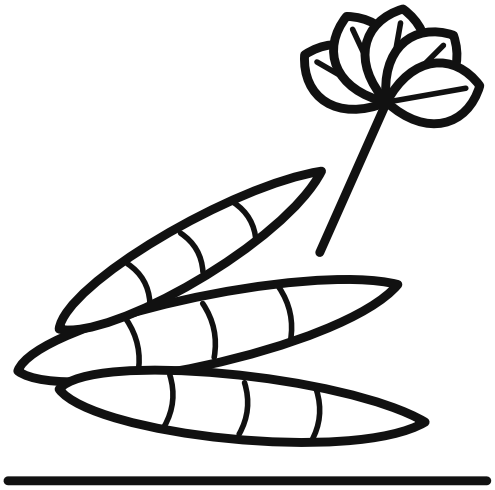
‘w’ as in “water”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu

Find W in the middle of *muwogo*.



WW **IS FOR**

muwogo

moo-woh-goh

cassava

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Yy

NAME · ERINNYA

ya

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu

Find Y near the end of *caayi*.



YY IS FOR

caayi

chaa-yee

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · ERINNYA

za

zah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

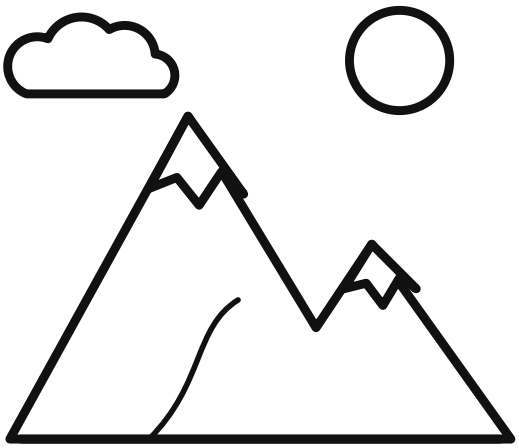
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LUGANDA NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «za»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu

Find Z at the end of *lusozi*.



ZZ IS FOR

lusozi

loo-soh-zee

hill, mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · WANDIIKA

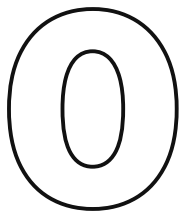
Zz Zz Zz Zz

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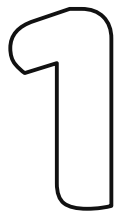
BONUS

Luganda numbers ennamba *(en-nah-mbah)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Luganda: *zeh-roh, eh-moo, bbee-ree, ssah-too...*



0
zeero
zeh-roh
zero



1
emu
eh-moo
one



2
bbiri
bbee-ree
two



3
ssatu
ssah-too
three



4
nnya
nnyah
four



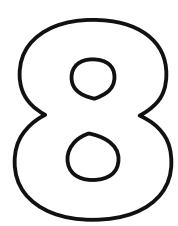
5
ttaano
ttaa-noh
five



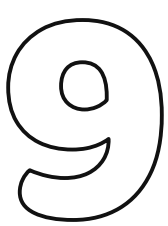
6
mukaaga
moo-kaa-gah
six



7
musanvu
moo-sah-nvoo
seven



8
munaana
moo-naa-nah
eight



9
mwenda
mweh-ndah
nine

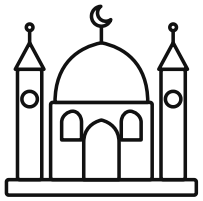
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LET'S TALK

My first Luganda words Ebigambo ebisooka

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum	*as-sah-laa-moo ah-lay-koom* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
Wa alaikum assalam	*wah ah-lay-koom as-sah-laam* **And peace be upon you (the reply)**
Oli otya? · Bulungi!	*oh-lee oh-tyah · boo-loo-ngee* **How are you? · Fine!**
Erinnya lyange nze ...	*eh-ree-nnyah lyah-ngeh nzeh ...* **My name is ...**
Webale	*weh-bah-leh* **Thank you**
Jazakallahu khairan	*jah-zah-kal-lah-hoo khai-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
maama · taata	*maa-mah · taa-tah* **Mother · Father**
muganda wange · mwannyinaze	*moo-gah-ndah wah-ngeh · mwah-nnyee-nah-zeh* **Brother · Sister**
yee · nedda	*yeh · neh-ddah* **Yes · No**
Njiga Oluganda!	*njee-gah oh-loo-gah-ndah* **I am learning Luganda!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

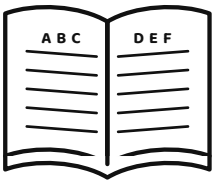
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

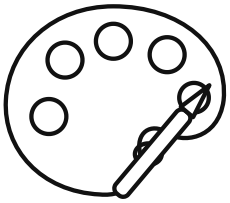
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **24 Luganda letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Luganda, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Okoze bulungi!

maa-shaa-lah! oh-koh-zeh boo-loo-ngee! — Mashallah! You did well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 24 letters of the Luganda alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
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